Needle Destroyer



Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Needle burner; Syringe destroyer; Syringe Destroyer and Needle Burner

What it is used for

A needle destroyer or syringe destroyer is used to disable or safely process used needles and syringes according to the device design and approved healthcare waste procedures. Correct handling and immediate disposal help reduce needlestick injuries and infection risks.

Main parts

- Device housing encloses the operating mechanism.
- Needle insertion port accepts compatible needles on applicable models.
- Cutting, melting, or destroying mechanism disables the needle according to the device design.
- Syringe cutting or disabling slot is provided on compatible models.
- Power switch activates the mechanism on powered models.
- Indicator light shows operating status on equipped models.
- Waste collection container receives processed sharps or separated components where provided.
- Power cord or battery supplies energy on powered models.

Before you start

1. Only trained and authorised healthcare personnel should operate the device.
2. Read the manual and confirm which needle and syringe types the device accepts.
3. Inspect the housing, insertion port, switch, power supply, and waste container for damage.
4. Wear the required PPE, including gloves and eye protection under local procedures.
5. Place the device on a stable, cleanable surface in the designated waste-handling area.
6. Prepare an approved sharps container and follow the facility's biomedical waste segregation rules.

How to use

1. Switch on the device according to the manufacturer's instructions, if it requires power.
2. Confirm the device is ready and all guards or covers are correctly positioned.
3. Hold the used syringe by its barrel and keep fingers away from the needle.
4. Insert only the compatible needle into the designated port without forcing it.
5. Activate the destruction mechanism using the approved control where required.
6. Verify that the needle has been processed as intended without touching the sharp end.
7. Place the remaining syringe and all processed components into the correct approved waste stream.
8. Repeat only for compatible items and keep the work area organised.
9. Switch off and disconnect the device when the task is complete, following the manual.

10. Close the sharps container when its fill limit is reached and clean the device exterior using the approved procedure.

⚠ Safety

- Never touch, bend, or manually remove a used needle unless the approved device procedure specifically requires a safe method.
- Never force an incompatible needle or syringe into the device.
- Keep hands away from cutting or heating elements and never bypass guards.
- Do not use the device if the housing, insertion port, or power supply is damaged.
- Follow local biomedical waste rules; processed sharps may still require approved sharps disposal.
- If a needlestick injury or blood exposure occurs, follow the facility's immediate exposure-response procedure and seek prompt medical assessment.

Care & storage

- Switch off and disconnect power before cleaning or maintenance.
- Clean and disinfect external surfaces using manufacturer-approved materials.
- Inspect the insertion port, guards, and waste container regularly for damage or blockage.
- Arrange authorised servicing for abnormal operation, overheating, or failed destruction.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using a needle or syringe type not supported by the device.
- Touching the needle tip or processed sharp components by hand.
- Putting processed sharps into general waste instead of the approved waste stream.
- Cleaning or clearing a blockage while the device is powered.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.